

Rep. Tom Emmer on America's Newsroom

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BILL:

now facing them and their lives and their families. So swing on over here, the House Majority Whip Republican Congressman Tom Emmer is here out of Minnesota. Sir, it's good to see you again. Good morning to you. And after a bout with some bad health, you're back at it. So congratulations.

REP. TOM EMMER:

I never stopped. You got to work in the House. I get it.

BILL:

OK. Republicans have a lot of money, as I just mentioned here, and you're spending it already, but you're spending it in places a lot of people wouldn't think. How do you see this right now today?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, I look at the what you just laid out. The one thing that I agree with, it's the turnout. I mean, that whole show, the gathering in Dallas last week was all about ginning up Republicans to understand, look, the president solved the border. The president's made this country safe. The president has worked on improving health for all Americans. All of these things have been achieved. It's not time to sit back. You've got to get up, get out and you've got to vote. That's the biggest thing. We've got the money to play in the races that we need to play in. Jillian and I were talking beforehand. Remember, we're the House. We're 435 pieces of geography. Each one has unique demographics. It's candidate or incumbent message and money. You just got to have enough money to do what you have to do. And the message matters. We're a little different than the big races, the statewide races. From this standpoint, it's a specific motivating. What is the issue or couple issues that are going to get people up off the couch and come out and vote for you? We were talking beforehand. In Minnesota, believe it or not, the number one issue, fraud. Isn't that surprising?

BILL:

Well, no, but it may be, as you also said, sir, it doesn't really reflect where the rest of the country is. These states all have their own, you know, people might be concerned about fraud and be glad that people are doing something about it, but they're not necessarily going to the polls over it outside of Michigan, outside of Minnesota, outside of Minnesota. Excuse me. Another thing here. You said it's all about the messaging. President Trump's messaging last week to the GOP was every time my name has been on the ticket, the party's done really well. So all you got to do voters is go to the polls and pretend that I'm up for reelection. This gets to the very heart of these questions about is there MAGA without President Trump going forward? Is that the right message you think for this cycle?

REP. TOM EMMER:

I believe there is. You can go back and you can find an Harris X survey that was published, I believe, in Newsweek. It was a survey on voter intensity, and for some reason, this particular survey broke out MAGA Republicans and Republicans, independents and Democrats. I don't know why they didn't break out communists, Marxists, whatever, but it just was Democrats. It found that close to 90 percent of MAGA Republicans said they were intending to vote. And by the way, back then, it had both Republicans and Democrats, just the name. It had them essentially tied, which was in July. Look, I like the map that we have. Nobody seems to be talking about the map. Bill, when you were pointing at your your weaknesses, you're right. We've got to be watching Pennsylvania. We've got to be watching Ohio. We've got to be watching Iowa. We've got to watch the border down in Arizona. Right. We've got we've got seats that we need to protect. And we've got great incumbents who always have a race, which is why I'm confident. But if you look, we start in the worst case. You lose four seats in California. And I'm just saying, let's assume based on the redistricting, you lose four there. You lose one in Salt Lake City, Utah. You start as a minus five. We're winning Maine's second congressional district. Paul LePage is going to win that district. That's a net minus four. You're getting a seat in Alabama. Net minus three. You're getting a seat in Tennessee. Net minus two. You're getting a seat in Louisiana. Net minus one. And I don't know if it's been reported out yesterday, but the Missouri case actually was argued before a three judge panel in the Eighth Circuit yesterday. So that could change. I haven't even talked about Texas.

BILL:

The math. Yeah.

REP. TOM EMMER:

The math that we do shows a net gain of 10 seats for Republicans based on the redistricting. Democrats are going to win in some spots, but you're going to win in more.

BILL:

Meanwhile, you mentioned at the very top about how some of these districts have very distinct issues for the people they represent. Here is Maria Salazar. She represents Miami-Dade Cuban-Americans, Hispanics, Latinos. She had a direct message just yesterday for the president. Watch here.

MARIA SALAZAR:

To help you get to the White House in 2024, feel betrayed today. You can be for immigration when Lincoln was for slavery and Reagan was for communism.

BILL:

We clip the top of that. The same Hispanics who help you get to the White House in 2024 feel betrayed today. How do you counter that? What do you do about that?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, this is Maria's number one issue, and it's not surprising. And the president's well aware of that. She's talked to the president. She's talked to the White House. Look, Maria has her opinion. And I'm sure that you're going to have to work with all the different demographics. But Bill, do you want the taxes to go way up? Do you want what we just came out of? The double-digit inflation and the stagnant negative growth? Or do you want to see this thing continue? The jobs report that we just had last week was three times what anybody was expecting. And it wasn't just the gig economy that was being impacted. It wasn't Uber and DoorDash. These

were high-paying, high-tech, and manufacturing jobs that provide benefits. I think that the choice is very clear. Caroline Levitt said it. This is between common sense versus communism or crazy.

BILL:

Sir, thanks for coming on. We watch it every hour of every day. We do. All right? Tom Emmerich. Thank you, sir. Especially this guy. Right. Thank you. November 3rd.

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